

- You create a Google Answers ID. This is different from your regular Google ID, and this ID will be used in all your Google Answers transactions, so as to protect your privacy. Correspondence concerning your questions will be sent to your Gmail ID by default (you need to have a Google ID in the first place in order to procure a Google Answers ID), but you can change this.

Your Answers ID will have “-ga” appended to it—so if the ID you create is “azsxdc”, you’ll be referred to as “azsxdc-ga”.

- After you’re done creating an ID, you post your question. There is a 50-cent fee just for insertion. This fee is non-refundable—even if your question vanishes into the void.
- You quote a price you’re willing to pay for your answer. These prices are high by Indian standards. Google says on the Answers page that you can get your question answered for “as low as \$2.00,” or but forget that figure—if you’re asking a question like the above, you’ll need to quote in the vicinity of \$50 or even \$100!
- Your question may or may not be taken up by an Answerer. Remember, Google is not God, and Google Answerers are not gods either. If no-one thinks they can answer your question, it will rot. If someone thinks he can, you’ll get an e-mail saying your question is being worked upon.
- You can, at this point, post clarifications to your question. You can include more details, what sites you referred to, and so on. This makes it easier for the Answerer to nail down useful information.
- In addition, random people with Answers IDs might decide to “Comment” upon your answer. These won’t come under the “Answers” section of your question page, but under “Comments.” If you think a certain comment serves your purpose, you can even cancel your question—unless it’s been “Locked,” meaning an Answerer is working on it right now.

- If and when you get an Answer, you’ll get an e-mail notification. Now, if you think the answer isn’t up to the mark, you can ask for further clarifications, and the Answerer will try and incorporate changes to the answer.
- At the end of it all, if you’re happy with what you get, you pay and possibly tip the Answerer. You also rate your Answerer. Be wise while rating the Answerer: if someone’s rating goes below a certain level, he can lose his job as an Answerer! A clarification is often in order before you shoot off a negative rating.

If you’re still not happy, you can apply for a refund.

## 5.2 This Is No Yahoo! Answers

Yahoo! Answers, if you’ve seen it, is entirely different. It’s hardly moderated; you’ll find hormonal teens asking puerile questions about sex; you’ll find people submitting homework questions; you’ll see questions like “Do you like blue?” or “What colour do you like?” and such. People who answer the questions can say things like “I don’t know” and post it as an answer; they might say derogatory things about the question-asker; and so on. Google Answers is much more formal—at least when it comes to the people supplying the answers, as you’ll find out from our example to follow.

All content at answers.google.com is moderated by what are known as “Editors.” So even if you think about it as a forum, be sure you express yourself concisely, clearly, and politely.

Which brings us to an important question: what can you ask at Google Answers? You’ll find the answer to this question at the FAQ section of the site, but in general, you can expect your question to be deleted if:

- It contains explicit content
- It deals with stuff like making bombs